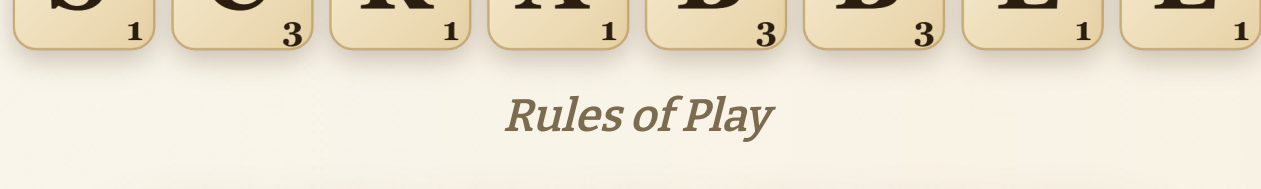
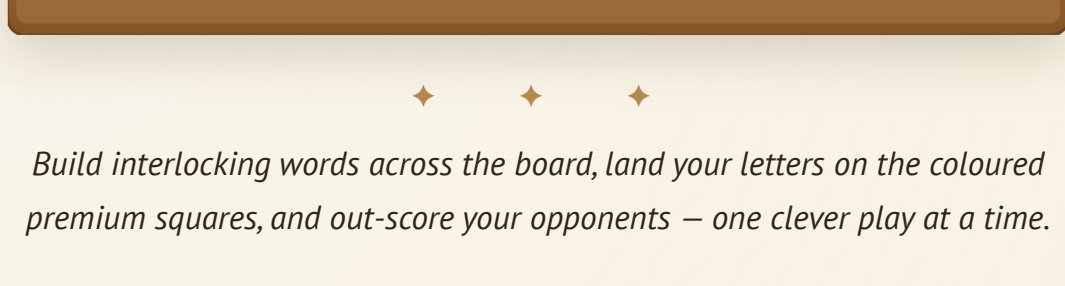


THE CLASSIC CROSSWORD GAME



Rules of Play



Build interlocking words across the board, land your letters on the coloured premium squares, and out-score your opponents – one clever play at a time.

2–4

PLAYERS

8+

AGES

30–60

MINUTES

100

TILES

15×15

BOARD

1 The Object of the Game

Make words. Score points. Win.

Players take turns building **interlocking words** – crossword-style – on the game board, using their lettered tiles. Each tile is worth points, and certain board squares multiply your score.

You add to your total every turn by forming new words and making the most of the premium squares. When the tiles run out and the last play is made, the player with the **highest score wins**.

★ It's not just big words – it's smart placement

A short word laid across a **Triple Word** square can beat a long word played on plain squares.

Position is everything.

2 Setup & Components

Two minutes and you're ready.

In the box

1 game board (15 × 15 squares) · **100 letter tiles** (98 letters + **2 blanks**) · 4 tile racks · 1 drawstring tile bag.

1 Place the board in the middle and put all **100 tiles in the bag**; give each player a **rack**.

2 **Decide who goes first**: each player draws one tile from the bag – the player with the letter **closest to "A"** starts (a blank beats everything). Return the tiles to the bag.

3 Each player draws **7 tiles** and stands them on their rack, hidden from the others.

3 The Tiles & Their Values

Common letters are cheap; rare letters are gold.

1 point	A ₁	E ₁	I ₁	O ₁	U ₁	L ₁	N ₁	S ₁	T ₁	R ₁
	×9	×12	×9	×8	×4	×4	×6	×4	×6	×6
2 points	D ₂	G ₂								
	×4	×3								
3 points	B ₃	C ₃	M ₃	P ₃						
	×2	×2	×2	×2						
4 points	F ₄	H ₄	V ₄	W ₄	Y ₄					
	×2	×2	×2	×2	×2					
5 points	K ₅									
	×1									
8 points	J ₈	X ₈								
	×1	×1								
10 points	Q ₁₀	Z ₁₀								
	×1	×1								
Blank										
	×2									

Worth 0 points – but can stand in for **any letter** (see §7).

4 The Board & Premium Squares

The coloured squares are where games are won.



Most squares are plain. The coloured ones **multiply your score** – but only on the turn a tile is **first placed** on them.

2L **Double Letter**

that letter scores ×2

3L **Triple Letter**

that letter scores ×3

2W **Double Word**

the whole word scores ×2

3W **Triple Word**

the whole word scores ×3

The centre star

★ where the first word must start – and it counts as a Double Word

5 Taking Your Turn

Play passes to the left.

On your turn you do **one** of three things: **play a word**, **exchange tiles**, or **pass**. After playing a word, draw new tiles to bring your rack back up to **seven**.

Building words

- Words read **left-to-right** or **top-to-bottom** – never diagonally or backwards.
- The **very first word** must cross the **centre star** and be at least two letters long.
- Every word after that must **connect to tiles already on the board**, adding to them, crossing them, or running alongside them.
- Every new sequence of letters** you create – in any direction – must be a valid word.



How it grows. The opening word **STORY** is laid across the centre star. A later turn adds **TOWN** downward, re-using the **T** already on the board.

Because **TOWN** hooks onto an existing tile, it's a legal play – and both words must be real words.

This is how the crossword steadily spreads across the board.

6 Scoring a Play

Add the letters, then apply the premiums.

- Add up the **letter values** of every tile in the word.
- Apply **letter premiums** first (2L, 3L) to the tiles sitting on them, then **word premiums** (2W, 3W) to the whole word.
- A premium square only counts **the turn its tile is first laid** – afterwards it's an ordinary square.
- If your play forms **several words at once** (by crossing others), **score every word** formed. A shared premium counts for each word that uses it that turn.
- Bingo!** Use **all seven** of your tiles in a single turn for a **+50 point** bonus.



Worked example. The opening **STORY** covers the centre star, so the whole word is doubled:

S-T-O-R-Y = 1+1+1+1+4 = **8**

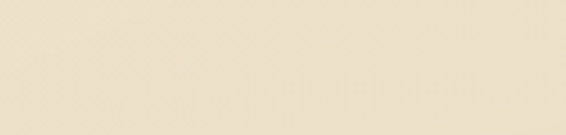
Centre star – Double Word ×2 = **16**

Later, **TOWN** is played downward. Its **O** lands on a **Double Letter** square:

T + (O×2) + W + N = 1+2+4+1 = **8**

The seven-tile bonus

Empty your whole rack in one play – like **JUKEBOX** below – and add **50 points** on top of the word's score. These "bingos" often decide the game.



7 Special Plays & Fine Print

Blanks, swaps, and what counts as a word.

Blank tiles

A blank can stand in for **any letter**. Say which letter it represents as you play it; it keeps that letter for the rest of the game. A blank always scores **0** – but placed on a word-premium it still multiplies the word.

Exchanging tiles

Instead of playing, swap any number of tiles: set them aside, draw the same number, then return yours to the bag. This **uses your whole turn**, and is only allowed while **seven or more tiles remain** in the bag.

Passing

You may pass at any time, scoring nothing. If **all players pass twice** in a row, the game ends.

Challenges

Any player may challenge a word before the next turn begins. Look it up: if it's **not** valid, the tiles come back and the player **loses that turn**. House rules vary – agree on a dictionary first.

What's a valid word?

Any word in your agreed dictionary is allowed. **Not** allowed: proper nouns, abbreviations, prefixes/suffixes on their own, or words needing a hyphen or apostrophe.

Little words, big help

Two-letter words (**QI**, **ZA**, **EX**, **JO**...) are a Scrabble player's best friend for slotting tiles onto premiums.

8 The End of the Game

Tally up – and mind the leftover tiles.

The game ends when **all tiles have been drawn** and **one player uses the last of their tiles** – or when no further plays are possible (everyone passes twice).

Final scoring

- Each player **subtracts** the total value of the tiles **left on their rack** from their score.
- The player who **"went out"** (used all their tiles) **adds** the total of **everyone else's leftover tiles** to their own score.
- The **highest final score wins**. In a tie, the player with the highest score *before* adjustments wins.

★ Don't get caught holding the Q

Those leftover tiles are subtracted from your score – and given to whoever finishes first. Try not to be left clutching the **Q** or **Z** when the bag runs dry.

A few friendly tips

- Hold onto an **S** and a **blank** – they open up big plays.
- Play **parallel** to existing words to form several short words at once.
- Balance your rack – a mix of vowels and consonants keeps your options open.
- Aim high-value tiles at **letter-premium** squares; aim everything at the **word-premium** squares.



Draw your seven tiles – and find that perfect word.

Scrabble · Rules of Play